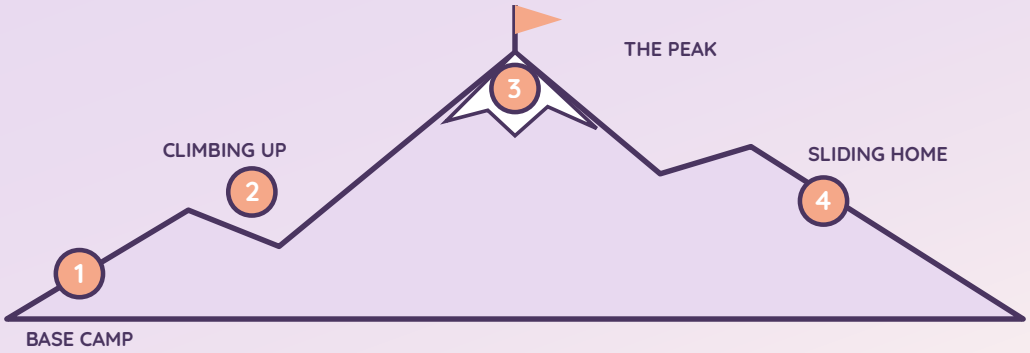
PRIMARY WRITING · CREATIVE STORIES

Guided Creative Story Builder



Step-by-step scaffolding, story starters and vocabulary helpers so you never get stuck on a blank page.

7 steps | Story Mountain plan

Years 3–5 · AC V9.0

Author name _____

Year level _____ Date _____

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Step 1: Stuck for an idea?

Use the Mix & Match Plot Generator.

Name _____ Date _____

How to use it

Roll a die (or simply pick one box from each column) three times: once for **Column A**, once for **B**, once for **C**. Mix them to spark your story idea!

The Plot Generator

Roll	Column A Main Character	Column B Story Setting	Column C Big Problem
	A clumsy young wizard	Inside a giant floating library	Lost the magic key to get home
	A detective wombat	At a midnight bush carnival	Someone stole the golden trophy
	A shy clockwork robot	On a treehouse city in the clouds	A thunderstorm is approaching fast
	A time-travelling baker	In an underwater coral palace	Must bake a cake for a grumpy dragon
	A miniature astronaut	Inside a forgotten attic	Trapped in a giant glass jar
	A talking koala librarian	On an island made of candy	The island is starting to melt

My rolls

Column A:  _____ Column B: _____ Column C: _____

My Chosen Story Spark (or my own brand-new idea)

My story is about

_____

who is

_____

and their big problem is that

_____

Parent/Teacher tip: Let your child roll three times, then challenge them to defend a silly combination: "How could a clumsy wizard end up in a candy island?"

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Step 2: Build your hero

A guided character profile.

Name _____ Date _____

Example model: what a good one looks like

Hero name: Barnaby Bramble | **Who they are:** a tiny, curious wombat wearing round spectacles.
Superpower / talent: can sniff out hidden tunnels underground. | **Biggest fear:** loud thunder and slimy frogs.
Main goal: Barnaby wants to find the lost Starlight Map before sunset so he can guide his family home.

1. Introduce your hero

My main character's name is _____

They are a _____ who lives in

_____

2. Pick or invent their special talent (tick one or write your own)

- ☐ They can turn invisible whenever they hold their breath.
- ☐ They can understand the secret language of animals and insects.
- ☐ They can invent clever gadgets out of everyday junk.
- ☐ My own idea: _____

3. Hero's fear and motivation

Even though my hero is brave, they are secretly terrified of

_____

More than anything in the world, my hero wants to

_____

because _____

4. Quick sketch of your hero (add labels for special items or clothes)

label: _____ label: _____

label: _____ label: _____

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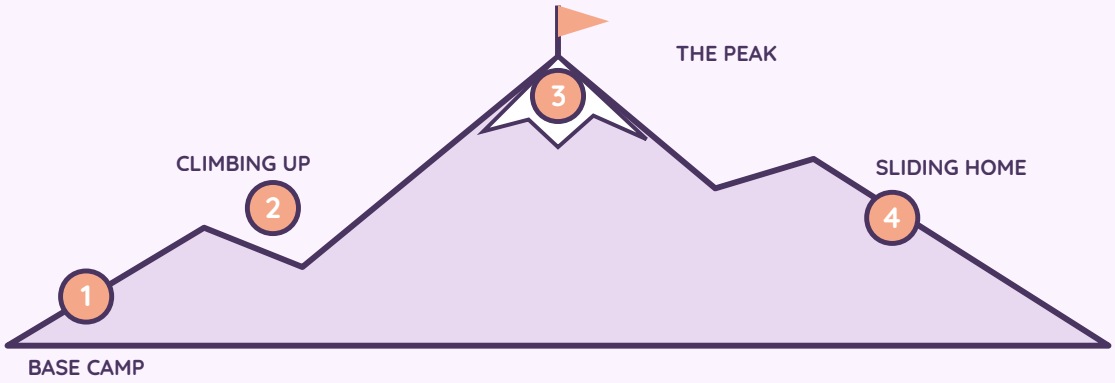
Step 3: The Story Mountain

Plan your plot step by step.

Name _____ Date _____

Every strong story climbs a mountain of excitement before reaching a satisfying ending

Fill in the four stages below.



Stage 1: BASE CAMP: Opening & setting the scene

Where is your hero at the start, and what normal activity are they doing before trouble begins?

Stage 2: CLIMBING UP: The problem strikes!

Suddenly, what goes wrong? What obstacle blocks your hero from reaching their goal?

Stage 3: THE MOUNTAIN PEAK: Climax & biggest challenge

At the scariest or hardest moment, what happens? How does your hero face their fear?

Stage 4: SLIDING HOME: Resolution & ending

How is the problem finally solved, and how does your hero feel at the very end?

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Step 4: Writer's toolkit

Sentence openers and boring vs. super sentences.

Name _____ Date _____

Avoid starting every sentence with "Then…" or "He…". Pick varied openers to hook your reader.

Time openers (When?)	Place openers (Where?)	Action openers (-ing words)
Suddenly, without warning,	Deep inside the shadowy cave,	Trembling from head to toe,
Just as the clock struck midnight,	High above the swirling clouds,	Holding their breath tightly,
Before anyone could blink,	Behind the creaking wooden door,	Dashing as fast as lightning,
Moments later,	At the edge of the whispering forest,	Peeking nervously around the corner,

Sentence upgrade example

Boring sentence: The boy walked into the dark room and was scared.

Super sentence (opener + adjectives + sense): Peeking nervously around the corner, Leo stepped into the freezing, pitch-black room as his heart hammered like a drum.

Your turn! Upgrade this boring sentence

Use a sentence opener and at least one sense. **Boring sentence:** "The girl found a box in the garden."

_____

_____

Opener I used:

_____

Extra practice: upgrade these too

1) "The dog ran down the street."

_____

_____

_____

2) "It was a sunny day."

_____

_____

_____

Parent/Teacher tip: Say the boring sentence aloud, then ask "Where? When? What can you see or hear?" and build the super sentence together.

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Step 5: Five senses and powerful adjectives

Name _____ Date _____

Word bank. Circle 4 or 5 words you promise to use!

Word bank

Sight (looks)	Sound (hears)	Touch (feels)	Smell & taste	Hero feelings
Shimmering	Echoing	Freezing	Smoky	Determined
Shadowy	Rustling	Slimy	Sweet	Anxious
Enormous	Thunderous	Prickly	Musty	Astonished
Flickering	Whispering	Velvety	Tangy	Courageous
Glowing	Creaking	Trembling	Fresh-baked	Relieved

The 4 or 5 words I will use in my story draft:

_____

My own powerful words

Sight: _____ Sound: _____

Touch: _____ Smell & taste: _____

Sense chart: describe my story setting

My setting is:

_____

Sense	What my hero notices
I see	
I hear	
I feel	
I smell / taste	

Feelings, shown not told

Instead of “She was scared”, write what her body does, for example: “Her knees knocked and her hands trembled.” Try one for your hero:

_____

_____

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Step 6: Guided story kick-off

Fill-in-the-blanks draft starter.

Name _____ Date _____

Use this scaffolded opening paragraph to launch your story smoothly

One morning in _____, _____ was busy _____.

Everything seemed peaceful until, without warning, _____ _____!

Even though _____ was terrified of _____, they took a deep breath and decided to …

Now continue your adventure

Remember your Story Mountain: base camp, climbing up, the peak, sliding home. Add a sentence opener and at least two senses.

Parent/Teacher tip: Read the paragraph aloud. Does it sound like a story that makes you want to find out what happens next?

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My story: part 1

Base camp and climbing up. Use your plan, openers and word bank.

Name _____ Date _____

Checklist while I write

☐ strong opener to hook my reader
☐ hero's name, goal and fear
☐ two senses in my setting
☐ the problem strikes!

My title

Write here

My story: part 2

The peak and sliding home. Show how your hero feels.

Name _____ Date _____

Checklist while I write

- ☐ a tense, exciting peak moment
- ☐ my hero faces their fear
- ☐ the problem is solved sensibly
- ☐ a satisfying ending with feelings

Write here

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Step 7: Young author final check

Tick each box only when you can prove it in your story.

Name _____ Date _____

My final check

- ☐ I used a strong **sentence opener** to hook my reader at the start.
- ☐ I described my setting and character using at least **two of the five senses**.
- ☐ My story has a clear **problem (peak)** and a sensible **ending (resolution)**.
- ☐ I checked all **capital letters, full stops and spelling** carefully.

Two stars and a wish (partner or parent)

★ Star 1: _____

★ Star 2: _____

✎ Wish: _____

How I feel about my story

My favourite sentence was: _____

Next time I want to improve: _____

My story rating: ☆ ☆ ☆ ☆ ☆

Teacher / parent comment

_____

_____

_____

_____

Official Author Signature

_____

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Teacher & parent guide

How to use this workbook.

Name _____ Date _____

Suggested use

Session 1: Step 1 (plot generator) and Step 2 (build the hero). **Session 2:** Step 3 (Story Mountain). **Session 3:** Steps 4 and 5 (openers, senses, word bank). **Session 4:** Step 6, then write parts 1 and 2. **Session 5:** Step 7, final check and sharing.

Success criteria

Skill	Getting started	Meeting	Strong
Ideas and plot	one idea, unclear problem	clear problem and ending	problem, peak and ending all linked
Openers	repeats “Then…”	uses 1–2 openers	varied openers throughout
Senses and adjectives	few details	2 senses	vivid, precise adjectives
Hero and feelings	name only	goal or fear shown	feelings shown, not just told
Punctuation and spelling	many errors	mostly correct	accurate and checked

Support and extension

Support: let the child choose from the plot generator, talk the story aloud first, write one stage at a time. **Extend:** write a second story with a different opener type each paragraph, add dialogue, or rewrite the ending as a twist. **Watch for:** every sentence starting the same way, feelings told not shown, a rushed ending, missing capitals and full stops.

Model paragraph (to read aloud)

Just as the clock struck midnight, Barnaby Bramble crept out of his burrow, his round spectacles glinting in the moonlight. Deep inside the shadowy cave, the air smelled musty and cold. Trembling from head to toe, the tiny wombat heard thunder rumble overhead. But the Starlight Map was waiting, and his family needed him. He took a deep breath and kept walking.

Curriculum links: Australian Curriculum V9.0 English (Creating texts)

Year	Code	Focus
Yr 3	AC9E3LY06	plan, create, edit and publish imaginative texts
Yr 3	AC9E3LE05	create and edit imaginative texts (characters, settings, plot)
Yr 4	AC9E4LY06	plan, create, edit and publish imaginative texts
Yr 4	AC9E4LE05	create and edit literary texts: storylines, characters, settings
Yr 5	AC9E5LY06	plan, create, edit and publish imaginative texts

Best fit: Years 3–4 (core), Year 5 as a scaffold. Check codes on the ACARA website before publishing.

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